Bug Reporting Template

Standard & Guidelines | [Organization Name] | Software Quality Assurance

1. Document Control

Document Title	Bug Reporting Template & Guidelines
Document ID	SQA-TPL-002
Version	1.0
Owner	SQA Manager
Approved By	*[Name, Designation]*
Effective Date	*[DD-MMM-YYYY]*
Review Cycle	Every 6 months, or whenever the defect process changes
Applies To	All projects, SQA engineers, developers and anyone who reports or triages defects

2. Purpose & Scope

This document defines one consistent way to report, classify, triage and close defects. A good bug report lets a developer reproduce the problem on the first attempt, lets the team lead judge its impact in seconds, and leaves a clear record of how it was resolved.

Use Section 6 (blank template) for every new bug. Section 7 shows a completed example. Section 5 holds the severity, priority, type and status definitions everyone must use. Section 8 is the checklist to complete before submitting. Section 9 provides the same fields as a column-wise log for teams that track bugs in a table or spreadsheet.

3. Ten Rules for Writing Good Bug Reports

1. **Search before you report.** Check for an existing report of the same problem. Add your details to it instead of raising a duplicate.
2. **One bug per report.** If two problems have different causes or fixes, raise two reports.
3. **Write a specific title.** Say where it happens, what is wrong and under what condition. The title is what people read in a list.
4. **Give reproducible steps.** Numbered, single-action steps starting from a known state, with exact test data.
5. **Separate expected from actual.** State both precisely and cite where the expectation comes from (requirement, test case, spec).
6. **Record the exact environment.** Build, environment, browser or app version, OS or device, user role and data used.
7. **Attach evidence.** Annotated screenshot, short recording, logs, network trace or API response, with timestamps where possible.
8. **Reproduce it more than once.** Retry at least twice and record how often it occurs. For intermittent bugs, note the pattern you saw.
9. **Rate severity objectively.** Use the definitions in Section 5. Priority is decided at triage, not by the reporter alone.

10. **Stay factual and neutral.** Describe behaviour, not people. Avoid opinions, blame and guesses about the cause.

Weak vs. Strong Titles

Weak	Strong	Why it is better
Login not working.	[Login] 'Invalid credentials' error shown for a valid user right after a password reset.	Location, symptom and trigger are clear.
Page is broken on mobile.	[Checkout] Pay button is hidden behind the footer on iPhone 14 (Safari) at 390 px width.	Exact element, device and condition.
It crashes sometimes.	[Reports] HTTP 500 when exporting more than 10,000 rows to Excel; 3 of 3 attempts.	Measurable trigger and frequency.

4. ID & Naming Conventions

Element	Format	Example
Bug ID	BUG-<PROJECT>-<NNNN>	BUG-PRT-0142
Title	[Module] <What is wrong> when <condition>	[Checkout] Order total not recalculated after removing an item when a coupon is applied
Attachments	<BUG-ID>_<short-description>.<ext>	BUG-PRT-0142_cart_total.png

Bug IDs are never reused. If a tool generates IDs automatically, use its ID in the same position.

5. Reference Values

Severity (technical impact, set by the reporter)

Severity	Definition	Typical examples
S1 - Critical	System crash, data loss or corruption, security breach, or a core flow is completely blocked with no workaround.	Payment fails for all users; data exposed to the wrong user
S2 - Major	Major function does not work as specified, or gives wrong results. A workaround may exist.	Cart total wrong after a change; export fails for large data
S3 - Minor	Function works but with limited impact, or an issue in a non-critical path.	Filter ignores one option; wrong sort order
S4 - Trivial	Cosmetic or wording issue with no effect on function.	Misaligned label, typo, tooltip text

Priority (urgency of the fix, set at triage)

Priority	Definition	Suggested target (adjust to your SLA)
P1 - Immediate	Must be fixed now. Blocks release or testing.	Triage within 4 hours; fix in current build or hotfix
P2 - High	Must be fixed before the next release.	Triage within 1 working day; fix in current release
P3 - Medium	Fix in a scheduled release.	Triage within 3 working days; plan into upcoming sprint
P4 - Low	Fix when capacity allows.	Review during backlog grooming

Severity and priority are independent. A typo on the home page is S4 but may be P2 before a launch. A crash in a rarely used admin screen may be S1 but P3.

Defect Type

Type	Use for
Functional	Behaviour that does not match requirements or acceptance criteria.
UI / UX	Layout, alignment, visual or interaction problems.
Data / Integrity	Wrong, missing, duplicated or corrupted data; calculation errors.
Integration / API	Failures between modules, services or third-party systems.
Performance	Slow response, timeouts, memory or resource problems.
Security	Authentication, authorization, session or data-protection weaknesses.
Compatibility	Problems on specific browsers, devices, OS versions or screen sizes.
Accessibility / Localization	Screen-reader, keyboard, language, date or currency format problems.
Content / Documentation	Wrong text, labels, help content or documentation.
Environment / Config	Problems caused by setup or configuration rather than code.

Bug Status Lifecycle

Status	Meaning	Set by
New	Reported and waiting for triage.	QA
Open / Assigned	Accepted, prioritised and assigned to a developer.	Team Lead
In Progress	Developer is working on the fix.	Developer
Fixed	Fix is complete and merged; awaiting deployment to the test environment.	Developer
Ready for Retest	Fix is deployed; QA can verify.	Developer / Lead
Closed	QA verified the fix and checked for regression.	QA
Reopened	Retest failed or the problem returned. Add details and the build tested.	QA
Rejected	Not a defect (works as designed). Reason and requirement reference are mandatory.	Team Lead / PM
Duplicate	Same as an existing bug. Link the original ID.	QA / Team Lead
Cannot Reproduce	Developer could not reproduce. QA to supply more detail within 2 working days or close.	Developer
Deferred	Valid but postponed to a later release with PM approval and a target release.	PM / Team Lead

6. Bug Report Template

Copy this section for each new bug. Grey italic text is guidance and should be replaced with real content. Sections A to G are completed by the reporter, Section H by the developer or team lead, and Section I by QA at retest.

A. Bug Summary

Bug ID	*BUG-<PRJ>-<NNNN>*	**Status**	*New*
Bug Title	*[Module] <What is wrong> when <condition>*		
Project / Product	*e.g., Customer Portal*	**Module / Feature**	*e.g., Checkout*
Severity	*S1 | S2 | S3 | S4*	**Priority**	*P1 | P2 | P3 | P4 (set at triage)*
Defect Type	*Functional | UI | Performance | Security | ...*	**Reproducibility**	*Always | Intermittent (x of y) | Once*
Reported By		**Date Reported**	*DD-MMM-YYYY*
Assigned To	*Developer / team*	**Found In (Phase)**	*System Test | Regression | UAT | Production*
Linked Test Case	*e.g., TC-PRT-CHK-014*	**Requirement / User Story**	*e.g., US-2087*

B. Environment

Build / Version	*e.g., v2.4.1-rc2*	**Environment**	*QA | UAT | Staging | Production*
Browser / App Version	*e.g., Chrome <version>*	**OS / Device**	*e.g., Windows 11 / iPhone 14*
User Role / Account	*Role and account used*	**Test Data Used**	*Dataset, coupon, record IDs*
URL / Screen / API	*Page URL, screen name or API endpoint*		

C. Description & Preconditions

Description	*Two or three sentences: what is wrong, where, and why it matters.*
Preconditions	*State required before step 1 (login, data, configuration).*

D. Steps to Reproduce

Step	Action	Test Data / Input
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

E. Expected vs. Actual Result

Expected Result	*What should happen, stated precisely.*
Actual Result	*What actually happened. Include exact error text or values.*
Source of Expectation	*Requirement ID, test case step, design or spec reference.*

F. Evidence

☐ Screenshot (annotated)	☐ Screen recording	☐ Application / server logs	☐ Console / network (HAR)
☐ API request & response	☐ DB query / data snapshot	☐ Stack trace / crash dump	☐ Other
Attachment names / links	*File names or links to screenshots, videos and logs.*		

G. Impact

Business / User Impact	*Effect on users or the business (blocked flow, wrong data, security exposure).*
Affected Users / Frequency	*Who is affected and how often.*
Workaround	*Steps users can take to avoid the problem, or 'None'.*

H. Triage & Fix (completed by Dev / Team Lead)

Triage Decision	*Accepted | Rejected | Duplicate | Deferred | Cannot Reproduce*	**Triaged By / Date**	
Root Cause Category	*Code | Requirement | Design | Data | Config | Environment | Third-party*	**Fixed By / Date**	
Root Cause Details			
Fix Description			
Fixed In Build		**Duplicate Of / Ref.**	

I. Retest & Closure (completed by QA)

Retested By		**Retest Date**	
Build Retested		**Retest Result**	*Pass (Close) | Fail (Reopen)*
Regression Checked	*Yes | No | N/A*	**Closed Date**	
Comments			

7. Worked Example

The example below is illustrative; the requirement, data and values are fictional. Sections H and I are blank because the bug has only just been reported.

A. Bug Summary

Bug ID	BUG-PRT-0142	**Status**	New
Bug Title	[Checkout] Order total not recalculated after removing an item when a coupon is applied		
Project / Product	Customer Portal	**Module / Feature**	Checkout / Cart
Severity	S2 - Major	**Priority**	P2 - High
Defect Type	Functional	**Reproducibility**	Always (3 of 3 attempts)
Reported By	S. Karim	**Date Reported**	05-Nov-2026
Assigned To	Checkout Dev Team	**Found In (Phase)**	System Testing
Linked Test Case	TC-PRT-CHK-014	**Requirement / User Story**	US-2087 / AC-2

B. Environment

Build / Version	v2.4.1-rc2	**Environment**	QA
Browser / App Version	Chrome (latest stable)	**OS / Device**	Windows 11
User Role / Account	Customer (qa.user02)	**Test Data Used**	Coupon SAVE10; items SKU-1001 and SKU-1002
URL / Screen / API	/cart		

C. Description & Preconditions

Description	After a 10% coupon is applied to a cart with two items, removing one item leaves the Order Total unchanged. The total corrects only after a manual page refresh, so a customer can proceed to payment with an incorrect total on screen.
Preconditions	Logged in as qa.user02 with an empty cart. Coupon SAVE10 (10% off) is active.

D. Steps to Reproduce

Step	Action	Test Data / Input
1	Add SKU-1001 to the cart.	SKU-1001 (price 500.00), qty 1
2	Add SKU-1002 to the cart.	SKU-1002 (price 300.00), qty 1
3	Open the Cart page and apply the coupon.	Coupon: SAVE10
4	Note the Order Total.	Shows 720.00 (correct)
5	Click Remove on SKU-1002.	-

E. Expected vs. Actual Result

Expected Result	Order Total updates immediately to 450.00 (500.00 less 10%) and the item count shows 1.

Actual Result	Item count shows 1 but Order Total remains 720.00. It changes to 450.00 only after refreshing the page.
Source of Expectation	US-2087 AC-2: cart totals recalculate on every cart change; TC-PRT-CHK-014, step 6.

F. Evidence

☒ Screenshot (annotated)	☒ Screen recording	☐ Application / server logs	☒ Console / network (HAR)
☐ API request & response	☐ DB query / data snapshot	☐ Stack trace / crash dump	☐ Other
Attachment names / links	BUG-PRT-0142_cart_total.png; BUG-PRT-0142_repro.mp4; BUG-PRT-0142_network.har		

G. Impact

Business / User Impact	Customer sees an incorrect order total in the cart and may continue to payment with a wrong amount displayed.
Affected Users / Frequency	Every customer who applies a coupon to a multi-item cart and then removes an item.
Workaround	Refresh the Cart page to force recalculation.

H. Triage & Fix (completed by Dev / Team Lead)

Triage Decision		**Triaged By / Date**	
Root Cause Category		**Fixed By / Date**	
Root Cause Details			
Fix Description			
Fixed In Build		**Duplicate Of / Ref.**	

I. Retest & Closure (completed by QA)

Retested By		**Retest Date**	
Build Retested		**Retest Result**	
Regression Checked		**Closed Date**	
Comments			

8. Pre-Submission Checklist

The reporter confirms every item before submitting a bug. A reviewer or team lead may return any report that fails one of these checks.

No.	Checklist item	Yes / No	N/A
1	Searched existing bugs; this is not a duplicate.	☐	☐
2	Title follows the format and clearly states location, problem and condition.	☐	☐
3	The report covers one problem only.	☐	☐
4	Steps are numbered, single-action and start from a stated precondition.	☐	☐
5	Exact test data and user role are given.	☐	☐
6	Expected and actual results are separate, precise and include exact error text or values.	☐	☐
7	Source of the expectation (requirement, test case or spec) is cited.	☐	☐
8	Environment details are complete: build, environment, browser or app version, OS or device.	☐	☐
9	Reproduced at least twice; reproducibility is recorded.	☐	☐
10	Evidence is attached and shows the problem clearly (annotated screenshot, video, logs).	☐	☐
11	Severity is chosen from the definitions; impact and workaround are stated.	☐	☐
12	Language is neutral and factual, with no blame or speculation about the cause.	☐	☐

Reporter		**Date**	
Reviewed By		**Decision**	*Accepted* | *Returned*

9. Column-wise Bug Log Template

One row per bug. Use this grid when bugs are tracked in a table or spreadsheet, or when importing into a bug tracking tool. Number the steps inside the Steps to Reproduce cell. The shaded row is an example; delete it before use.

Bug ID	Title	Module	Build	Env.	Severity	Priority	Type	Steps to Reproduce	Expected	Actual	Status	Owner	Reported By / Date	Linked TC
BUG-PRT-0142	*[Checkout] Total not recalculated after item removal with coupon*	*Checkout*	*v2.4.1-rc2*	*QA / Chrome / Win 11*	*S2 - Major*	*P2 - High*	*Functional*	*1. Add SKU-1001 and SKU-1002.* *2. Apply coupon SAVE10.* *3. Remove SKU-1002.*	*Total = 450.00 immediately*	*Total stays 720.00 until refresh*	*New*	*Checkout Dev*	*S. Karim 05-Nov-26*	*TC-PRT-CHK-014*

Column Guide

Column	What to enter	Allowed values / format
Bug ID	Unique ID following BUG-<PROJECT>-<NNNN>, or the tracker's ID. Never reused.	e.g., BUG-PRT-0142
Title	[Module] what is wrong, and when it happens.	One problem per bug
Module	Application area or feature where the bug occurs.	As defined in the test plan
Build	Build or version in which the bug was found.	e.g., v2.4.1-rc2
Env.	Environment, browser or app version and OS or device.	QA | UAT | Staging | Production + client details
Severity	Technical impact of the defect.	S1 | S2 | S3 | S4
Priority	Urgency of the fix, set at triage.	P1 | P2 | P3 | P4
Type	Category of the defect.	Functional | UI | Data | Integration | Performance | Security | Compatibility | ...
Steps to Reproduce	Numbered, single-action steps with exact test data.	1., 2., 3. ...
Expected	What should happen, with source reference where possible.	Exact message, value or state
Actual	What happened, including exact error text or values.	Exact message, value or state
Status	Current stage in the lifecycle.	New | Open | In Progress | Fixed | Ready for Retest | Closed | Reopened | Rejected | Duplicate | Cannot Reproduce | Deferred
Owner	Developer or team currently responsible for the fix.	Name or team
Reported By / Date	Person who reported the bug and the date reported.	Name, DD-MMM-YY
Linked TC	Test case that exposed the bug, if any.	e.g., TC-PRT-CHK-014

Tip: if your tool needs more fields (attachments, root cause, fixed-in build, retest result, closed date), append them as extra columns using the same names as Section 6.